Colette's Coq au Vin

Mullins Family Recipe - December 2025
Yields 6-8 servings | Prep: 30 min | Cook: 2.5 hrs

Ingredients

- 4 lbs bone-in chicken thighs and drumsticks
- 1 bottle Burgundy or Cotes du Rhone red wine
- 2 cups chicken stock (homemade preferred)
- 6 strips thick-cut bacon, cut into lardons
- 1 lb pearl onions, blanched and peeled
- 8 oz cremini mushrooms, quartered
- 3 medium carrots, rough chopped
- 2 stalks celery, rough chopped
- 6 cloves garlic, minced
- 2 tbsp tomato paste
- 4 sprigs fresh thyme
- 2 bay leaves
- Salt and freshly ground black pepper
- 2 tbsp all-purpose flour (for dusting)
- 3 tbsp butter, divided
- 2 tbsp olive oil
- Fresh flat-leaf parsley, chopped (for garnish)

Instructions

1. Marinate (optional): The night before, combine chicken with wine, thyme, bay, carrots, and celery. Refrigerate overnight. Drain and pat dry before cooking. Reserve marinade.

2. Brown the bacon: In a large Dutch oven over medium heat, render the lardons until golden and crisp. Remove with a slotted spoon. Leave fat in pot.

3. Brown the chicken: Season chicken with salt and pepper, dust lightly with flour. Brown in batches in the bacon fat plus 1 tbsp butter, about 4 minutes per side. Remove and set aside.

4. Build the base: Add onions to pot. Cook until golden, about 5 minutes. Add mushrooms and cook 3 minutes more. Add garlic and tomato paste. Cook 1 minute.

5. Deglaze and braise: Return bacon and chicken to pot. Pour in wine and stock. Add thyme and bay leaves. Bring to gentle simmer.

6. Slow cook: Cover and cook on lowest heat for 2 to 2.5 hours, turning chicken once halfway. Chicken should be very tender, pulling away from bone.

7. Finish the sauce: Remove chicken and vegetables. Strain braising liquid into saucepan. Reduce by one-third over medium-high heat. Whisk in remaining 2 tbsp butter for gloss. Adjust seasoning.

8. Serve: Return chicken to pot with sauce. Garnish with parsley. Serve with crusty bread or over wide egg noodles.

Notes

Best made the day before - the flavors deepen overnight in the refrigerator. Reheat gently.
Family tradition for Sunday dinners, especially in October and November when the weather turns.
Etienne prefers a splash of cognac added with the wine. I prefer it without. This is the source of our most recurring disagreement.